

From prototype to trusted weekly workflow

A sequential plan for moving from a fictional-data prototype to a permission-aware system used by Programs and Impact. The stages are gates, not calendar promises.

WHERE THIS STARTS

Compass currently proves the difficult pattern: retrieval across uneven records, permission-aware access, cited answers, conflict surfacing, and refusal when evidence is weak. It has not touched Foundation systems or real grant data. The plan below introduces reality in controlled steps.

Three ordering rules

- **Decide irreversible boundaries first.** Access, sensitive-data rules, contracts, and source ownership are agreed before indexing.
- **Earn trust with a few people.** A small design-partner group tests real work before access widens.
- **End every stage with a leadership decision.** Continue, revise, narrow, or stop based on evidence.

STAGE	PURPOSE	ENTRY	EXIT GATE
1. Discover	Lock the decisions that are expensive to change later.	Named sponsor and source owners	Approved access, corpus, sensitivity tiers, and test questions
2. Prove	Test a narrow real workflow with real users.	Signed discovery decisions	Correct cited answers, verified controls, and partner trust
3. Harden	Make the core safe and complete for Programs and Impact.	Pilot evidence supports widening	Five-year reconciliation, security closure, and team adoption
4. Widen	Extend reach and transfer ownership.	Core workflow is trusted	Named owner can operate and release it without the fellow

WHAT NEVER CHANGES

- Read-only source connections.
- Every important statement links to evidence.
- If access is uncertain, show less.
- A person owns every grant and impact decision.
- Every change is tested and documented.

Discover, then prove

The first half of the plan converts assumptions into signed decisions, then tests one useful workflow against real evidence.

Stage 1: Discover

1	Select design partners	Choose 3 to 5 weekly users and one accountable data owner.
2	Inventory sources	Confirm content, owners, permissions, retention, history, and shadow systems.
3	Confirm read-only access	Test the narrowest viable access to Drive, GivingData, and Airtable.
4	Resolve legal and vendor terms	Confirm no-training and retention terms, data-processing terms, and co-funder restrictions.
5	Approve the sensitivity model	Name the tiers and the Never-ingest locations and record types.
6	Build the source-of-truth map	For each fact, decide which system owns it and who resolves conflict.
7	Define the first corpus	Choose grants, date range, folders, tables, and explicit exclusions.
8	Create the evaluation set	Write about 50 real questions with reviewer-approved answers and refusal cases.
9	Measure the baseline	Record current time and effort for renewal preparation and portfolio research.

EXIT GATE

The data owner approves access, sensitivity tiers, the corpus, and exclusions. Leadership agrees on the success measure and the evaluation set exists.

Stage 2: Prove

10	Connect the first source pair	Begin with GivingData and approved Drive content, read-only.
11	Preserve evidence metadata	Keep version, date, access list, link, and content fingerprint.
12	Resolve a small grant set	Connect about 30 grants to organizations, funds, and documents. Send uncertain matches to review.
13	Enforce access before retrieval	Filter in the database, not only in the model prompt.
14	Return a cited answer	Show what was searched, what was unavailable, conflicts, and a plain refusal when support is weak.
15	Release to design partners	Use real Google sign-in and a narrow web workflow.
16	Turn on operational controls	Audit history, emergency off switch, usage limits, and revocation checks.
17	Run weekly feedback	Capture corrections and convert approved examples into regression tests.
18	Attack-test every change	Use planted manipulation documents and block regressions.

Exit gate: Design partners receive correct, cited answers to real questions; no permission leak appears in testing; the audit record and off switch are verified.

Harden, then widen

Only after the pilot earns trust do we complete historical coverage, add integrations, and transfer operating ownership.

Stage 3: Harden

19	Add Airtable	Bring in approved relationship and cohort context with its original access rules.
20	Control personal data	Detect and redact named participant data; exclude identifiers from search.
21	Expand adversarial tests	Add a larger manipulation set and require automatic passing.
22	Reconcile five years	Handle old templates, duplicate records, migration gaps, and conflicting versions.
23	Support multilingual evidence	Test Spanish retrieval and scan quality for relevant reporting.
24	Make quality a release gate	Block releases when answer quality, permissions, or safety regress.
25	Operationalize review	Add an admin queue and a clean reconciliation report.
26	Independent security review	Commission an outside test, remediate findings, and verify the fixes.
27	Onboard the full group	Train Programs and Impact with role-specific examples and office hours.

EXIT GATE

The five-year corpus reconciles, security findings are closed, the release gate is working, and Programs and Impact are using the system.

Stage 4: Widen

28	Meet users where they work	Add one approved surface, such as a GivingData view or team-chat interface.
29	Run a governed improvement loop	Turn reviewed feedback into one tested change at a time.
30	Report adoption and trust	Track use, time saved, corrections, refusal quality, coverage, and cost.
31	Transfer release ownership	A named owner runs refresh, tests, release, rollback, and incident steps independently.
32	Deliver the expansion decision	Leadership decides on Zoom Chat and Foundation-wide access with evidence in hand.
33	Exercise incident response	Run a tabletop scenario and update the playbook.

EXIT GATE

The system has a named owner, that owner can operate it independently, leadership has an evidence-based expansion decision, and incident response has been exercised.

How the work stays fast and accountable

Parallel work is encouraged inside a stage. Crossing a gate remains sequential because the next stage depends on the previous decision.

WORKSTREAM	ACCOUNTABLE PARTNER	EVIDENCE OF PROGRESS
Program workflow	Programs lead and design partners	Priority questions, approved examples, feedback, time saved
Impact integrity	Impact lead	Source ownership, model versioning, projection versus result rules
Data and access	Data owner and system administrators	Approved corpus, permission tests, revocation checks, reconciliation
Security and privacy	COO office, counsel, and technical reviewer	Vendor terms, control tests, findings, incident exercise
Product and delivery	Fellow with COO sponsor	Working slices, documentation, decisions, release and rollback

Decision scorecard at every gate

USEFULNESS

- Does it improve a named workflow?
- Are users returning voluntarily?
- Is the time or quality improvement visible?

TRUST

- Can reviewers verify each important statement?
- Does it expose gaps and conflict?
- Do users understand what it cannot see?

SAFETY

- Did permission and attack tests pass?
- Can access be revoked promptly?
- Are exclusions and sensitive tiers intact?

OPERABILITY

- Can another person run and release it?
- Are costs, failures, and audit events visible?
- Is rollback documented and tested?

What the Foundation must provide

- One accountable data owner.
- Two design partners who test weekly.
- Read-only access to the approved source scope.
- Timely decisions on contracts, confidentiality, and source ownership.

THE END STATE

A cited, permission-aware assistant used for real program and impact work, with reconciled historical coverage, a documented security posture, measurable value, and a named internal owner. Expansion remains a leadership decision, not an assumption.